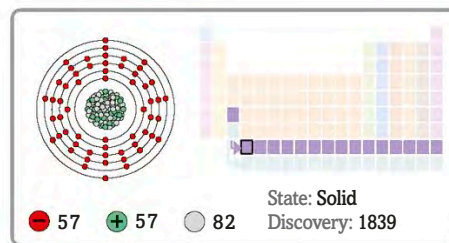


57
La

Lanthanum



Forms

Lanthanum carbonate is used to treat patients with **kidney disease**.

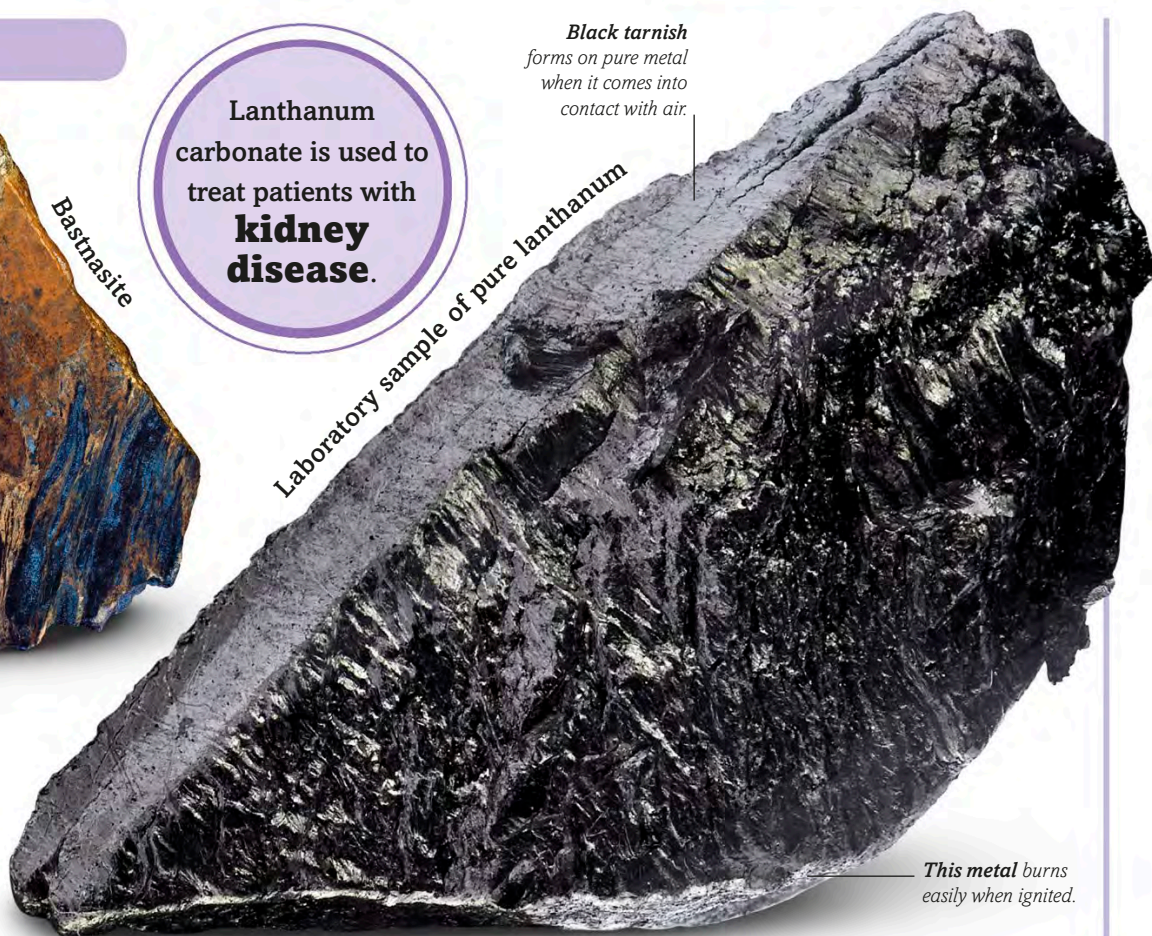


This reddish-brown mineral is also found in other colours, including white, tan, and grey.

Bastnasite

Laboratory sample of pure lanthanum

Black tarnish forms on pure metal when it comes into contact with air



This metal burns easily when ignited.

Uses

Fluorescent lamp



This lamp uses lanthanum to reduce the yellow colour in its light.



Molten lanthanum

This lens can better focus light on an object due to the presence of lanthanum oxide in the glass.

In its molten state, lanthanum is used to smooth rough diamonds.



Camera lens

Although the word “lanthanum” means “to lie hidden”, it is more abundant than most metals. For example, it is three times more common than lead. This element was discovered in the mineral cerite in 1839. However, it took chemists almost another

100 years to find a way to purify the metal. Today, the mineral **bastnasite** is a source of **pure lanthanum**. The element’s applications range from its use in film studio lights and **lens-making** to refining petroleum.